09-14 第2篇

阅读理解（记叙文） The First Time I Cooked a Full Dinner for My Parents

① On a quiet Saturday morning in late September, I made a decision that surprised even me: **I would cook the whole family dinner that evening — by myself**. I was almost fourteen, had never cooked more than a simple egg before, and our kitchen still felt slightly scary to me. Yet my mother had been coming home tired at nine o'clock every night for three weeks, and my father had a small cold that would not go away. "A dinner," I thought, sitting on the edge of my bed, "is a kind of answer."

② I did not tell them. I wanted a surprise. At breakfast I asked, as casually as I could, "What do you feel like for dinner tonight?" Mum was yawning over her tea. She smiled a tired smile. "Anything simple. Really anything." Dad nodded. "Don't fuss." They had no idea, of course, that a plan was already growing in my head.

③ I made my menu at the kitchen table: **egg-and-tomato stir-fry**, **stir-fried green beans with minced pork**, a small **cucumber salad**, and a pot of **plain white rice**. Four items. I looked at the list and felt small panic run down my back. It was four more items than I had ever cooked in my life. I wrote the shopping list twice. Then I put on my shoes, took my mother's folded cloth bag, and walked out to the market — the first time I had gone there alone with **real money** in my pocket.

④ The market was a small busy world of its own. An old man with a kind face sold me two ripe red tomatoes; a lady with quick hands weighed a small bunch of fresh green beans; a butcher in a white apron laughed at my serious face as he packed 100 grams of minced pork. "Young chef, first time?" he asked. I nodded, a little embarrassed. He wrapped the pork a bit more carefully after that. On the way home, my bag was warm with vegetables, my head full of next steps.

⑤ Back in the kitchen, the real battle began. I washed the rice three times, because I had read in a small cooking book that good rice "needs clear water". I chopped the green beans into neat pieces the size of my little finger. I tried to cut the cucumber into thin slices and nearly cut myself in the process — the knife was sharper than I had guessed. I learned, in twenty small ways, that a kitchen looks peaceful only after someone has practised many years.

⑥ The hardest moment was the egg-and-tomato stir-fry. The oil jumped when I dropped in the eggs; I jumped too. A small splash landed on the back of my hand and made me bite my lip for a second. I turned down the heat. My grandmother's voice came back to me from a long-ago summer: "**Turn the flame a little lower, child. Big fire, small**

confidence." I slowed down. The eggs slowly became a soft yellow cloud; the tomatoes softened into a warm red; everything came together in a way that looked, for a moment, almost like my mother's.

⑦ At six o'clock, the table was set. White rice in a round blue bowl; a small plate of cucumber salad shining with a few drops of soy sauce and sesame oil; bright yellow and red egg-and-tomato in an old white dish; stir-fried green beans with pork from my grandmother's small iron pan. My hands smelled of oil, soap and spring onions. I sat down, tired in a way that felt completely new — not like after a long exam, but like after a long hike, warm and useful.

⑧ My mother came home first. She opened the door, stopped, sniffed the air, and stared at the table. "You didn't —" she started. "I did," I said, my voice a little unsteady. "Sit down." Dad came in a few minutes later, his nose still a bit red from the cold. His eyes went slowly from me, to the table, back to me. He sat down without saying anything and reached for his chopsticks. Three bites in, he put them down. "Lily," he said, very quietly, "this tastes like home." He looked up, and I noticed that his eyes were shiny. "You grew up tonight."

⑨ I did not sleep well that evening — the kitchen was not yet clean, my hand still stung a little, and I kept replaying how my green beans turned out a tiny bit salty. But something larger had changed. In one Saturday, our kitchen had stopped being a scary adult room and had become, partly, **mine**. Since then, I cook at least one dinner every week. The dishes still aren't perfect. My mother still laughs at my chopping. But when my parents come in tired on a Friday night now, they no longer ask "What's for dinner?" They only ask "What is Lily cooking?" — and I am already there, in the warm cloud of steam, answering.

注释： stir-fry 炒菜；minced pork 猪肉末；apron 围裙；splash 溅出；soy sauce 酱油

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. Why did the writer decide to cook a full dinner by herself that Saturday?

A. Because she had a school cooking contest that evening.
B. Because her mother had been coming home tired very late every night for three weeks, and her father had a cold; a dinner seemed a kind of answer.
C. Because she wanted to win money from her parents.
D. Because her parents had ordered her to cook.

2. Why did the butcher at the market wrap the minced pork a bit more carefully?

A. Because the writer paid twice as much money.
B. Because the writer had a dog with her.

C. Because he noticed it was her first time cooking, so he packed it more carefully.
D. Because she forgot her shopping bag.

3. What did the writer remember her grandmother saying, in the middle of the difficult egg-and-tomato stir-fry?

A. "Pour more oil, be brave."
B. "Turn the flame a little lower, child. Big fire, small confidence."
C. "Never cook eggs in the morning."
D. "Leave the kitchen and call a restaurant."

4. How did the writer's father react after the first few bites of dinner?

A. He said the food was very bad and stopped eating.
B. He put down his chopsticks, said quietly, "this tastes like home," and his eyes became shiny.
C. He laughed loudly and left the table.
D. He asked the writer to cook everything again.

5. What change in the family has happened since that Saturday, according to the last paragraph?

A. The writer's parents now cook every single meal themselves.
B. The writer stopped cooking after one attempt.
C. The writer now cooks at least one dinner each week; her parents come home asking "What is Lily cooking?" rather than "What's for dinner?"
D. The family has started eating only outside in restaurants.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段 "my mother had been coming home tired at nine o'clock every night for three weeks, and my father had a small cold ... 'A dinner,' I thought, 'is a kind of answer.'"
【解析】母亲疲惫、父亲感冒使"我"想以一顿饭回应爱。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段 "'Young chef, first time?' ... He wrapped the pork a bit more carefully after that"
【解析】屠夫见其初次下厨便格外仔细包装。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑥段 "'Turn the flame a little lower, child. Big fire, small confidence.'"
【解析】外婆提醒要小火、有耐心。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑧段 "he put them down. 'Lily,' he said, very quietly, 'this tastes like home.' ... his eyes were shiny"
【解析】爸爸放下筷子感慨并有泪光。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨/细节题
【定位】第⑨段 "I cook at least one dinner every week ... 'What is Lily cooking?'"
【解析】"我"每周至少做一顿饭，家人等候的称呼变为她。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。